

Bet You Didn't Know

Real Estate: The one thing you can never have enough of is screen real estate. You can get more real estate for yourself if you press [Tab]. This hides the palettes and lets you enlarge your Timeline and monitor panes. To get the palettes back, all you need to do is press [Tab] again.

a box where you can choose to either speed up or slow down the clip in terms of percent, or in terms of time. So if you created a clip that is, say, two minutes long, you can speed it up by 200 per cent, or just speed it up to be one minute long. You can also slow it down or play it backwards! Doing this also reverses the audio to play backwards. Check the 'Reverse Speed' and 'Maintain Audio Pitch' checkboxes to play the clip backwards and maintain the audio pitch as you slow down or speed up the clip.

Cut!

When editing video files, the most important thing you need to know is how to cut and join clips. Joining different clips together is easy using the Timeline pane. All you need to do is drag and place one clip after another to join them. Cutting clips is a little more complicated, though. You need to select the 'Razor' tool from the Tool Palette or press [C].



Use the razor tool to cut a clip into two parts at a given location



Now, carefully mark the point in the timeline you wish to cut the clip at, and click on it using the Razor tool. Make sure you zoom in to mark the exact frame where you want to cut. This will cut the clip into two separate clips. Now you can drag and place the two portions as you please. Press [V] to get back the Selection tool.

Separating Audio and Video

In the Timeline pane, when you add a video clip, its audio track is added automatically. If you drag the audio to the left or right, the video moves with it too. This is good as you

need not worry about messing up the original clip. However, sometimes you may need to correct the original, say, for example, when the audio and video are slightly off sync.

To do this, you need to unlink the audio and video. Just select the track, and right-click on it. Choose 'Unlink Audio and Video'. Now you can move the audio and video tracks independently. You can also do the same thing by holding down [Alt] while dragging either the audio or video. Using the [Alt] key when dragging only temporarily unlinks the audio and video, so you do not need to go back and link them once you have placed them as desired.



Use 'Unlink Audio and Video' to edit only a video track or to correct a Lipsync problem

Video Capture

You can use Adobe Premiere Pro to capture digital video and store it to your hard disk. All you need to do is connect the digital camera or playback device to the computer using an IEEE 1394 cable.

Open Adobe Premiere Pro and create a new project, using File > New > Project, or [Ctrl] + [N]. Now, go to File >



Video device to capture video on the fly with Premiere Pro—all you need to do is connect the device to the PC using an IEEE 1394 cable!

Reader Tip

Extracting a song from a movie CD using VirtualDub: First open the movie file in VirtualDub. Now, in the Audio menu, make sure the Direct Stream Copy option is selected. After the options are saved, select the portion you want to extract. Just move the TimeLine slider until you reach the starting point of the song you want to extract. Press [Home] to mark the start position of the song. Now move the slider until you reach the

end position of the song you want to extract. Press [End] to mark this position. Click on File > Save Wav and enter the location where you want to save this file as Temp.wav. As WAV files are uncompressed format, this will be a huge file but don't worry, you can convert this file to MP3 later, using encoders such as RazorLame.

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